

Dracula2 - Exfiltration Progression Pitch

Short Pitch

A gothic exfiltration game where you play Dracula during the final nights before the Demeter sails. Hunt, enthrall, sabotage, and prepare your passage while the surrounding villages awaken to what you are.

Core Reframe

The game is not about Dracula surviving frightened villagers. It is about Dracula completing a strategic exfiltration before the land closes around him.

Dracula is powerful, old, arrogant, and dangerous. The villagers are not individually stronger than him. They matter because they can act during daylight, organize faster than one person can be everywhere, bless roads, burn refuges, destroy earth-boxes, delay cargo, and force him into bad timing.

The real enemy is not the mob. The real enemy is exposure, consecration, daylight, logistics, and the shrinking map.

Main Objective

Prepare the Demeter voyage before dawn on the final night.

To leave Transylvania, Dracula must:

- p
r
e
p
a
r
e

a
n
d

m
o
v
e

n
a
t
i
v

e
-
e
a
r
t
h

c
r
a
t
e
s

t
o
w
a
r
d

t
h
e

p
o
r
t

-s

e
c
u
r
e

p
a
p
e
r
s
,

c
o
i
n

,

m
a
n
i
f
e
s
t
s

,

o
r

a

s
h
i
p
p
i
n
g

a
r
r
a
n
g
e
m
e
n
t

-o

p
e
n

a

r
o
u
t

e

f

r

o

m

c

a

s

t

l

e

t

o

p

o

r

t

-p

r

o

t

e

c

t

o

r

r

e

l

o

c

a

t

e

d

a

y

l

i

g

h

t

r
e
f
u
g
e
s
-m
i
s
d
i
r
e
c
t
,
w
e
a
k
e
n
,
o
r
d
i
v
i
d
e
t
h
e
v
i
l
l
a
g
e
r

s

- enthrall useful human agents such as a clerk, coachman, sailor, innkeeper, or
priest's assistant

- b

o

a

r

d

o

r

s

e

a

l

t

h

e

c

a

r

g

o

b

e

f

o

r

e

t

h

e

v

i

l

l

a

g

e

r

s

u

n
d
e
r
s
t
a
n
d

t
h
e

f
u
l
l

p
l
a
n

The countdown is not "hide for seven days." The countdown is "complete the passage before the countryside becomes impossible to cross."

Night Loop

Each night, Dracula chooses a limited number of actions before dawn.

Possible night actions:

- F
e
e
d

t
o

r
e
g
a
i
n

s
t

r
e
n
g
t
h
,

r
e
d
u
c
e

h
u
n
g
e
r
,

o
r

c
r
e
a
t
e

l
e
v
e
r
a
g
e

o
v
e
r

a

h
o
u
s
e
h
o
l
d
.

-S

c
o
u
t

t
h
e

v
i
l
l
a
g
e
,

r
o
a
d
,

m
o
n
a
s
t
e
r
y
,

p
o
r

t

,

o

r

c

a

t

a

c

o

m

b

s

.

-M

o

v

e

a

n

e

a

r

t

h

c

r

a

t

e

o

n

e

s

t

e

p

c

l

o

s

e
r

t
o

t
h
e

r
o
a
d
,

c
o
a
c
h

d
e
p
o
t
,

r
i
v
e
r
,

o
r

p
o
r
t
.
-E
n
t
h
r

a
l
l

a

h
u
m
a
n

a
g
e
n
t

w
h
o

c
a
n

a
c
t

d
u
r
i
n
g

t
h
e

d
a
y

.

-S

a
b
o

t
a
g
e

b
e
l
l
s
,

w
a
t
c
h
f
i
r
e
s
,

r
o
a
d
s
,

b
r
i
d
g
e
s
,

k
e
n
n
e
l
s
,

o
r

c
h
u
r
c
h

d
e
f
e
n
s
e
s

.

- Recover old castle assets such as wolf kennels, mist rites, sealed crypt passages, or buried coin.

- S

i
l
e
n
c
e

a

w
i
t
n
e
s
s

,

w
i
t
h

t
h
e

r
i
s
k

o
f

i
n
c
r
e
a
s
i
n
g

f
e
a
r

a
n
d

i
n
v
e
s
t
i
g
a
t
i
o
n

.

-F
o
r
g
e

o

r

s
t
e
a
l

t
r
a
v
e
l

d
o
c
u
m
e
n
t
s

,

m
a
n
i
f
e
s
t
s

,

c
a
r
g
o

p
a
p
e
r
s

,

o
r

s
e
a
l
s
.
- P
r
e
p
a
r
e

t
h
e

D
e
m
e
t
e
r

c
a
r
g
o
.

The player should feel predatory at night. Dracula is not creeping around because he is weak. He is choosing where the countryside will bleed, lie, sleep, or fail tomorrow.

Day Loop

During the day, Dracula cannot freely correct mistakes. The villagers, church, officials, and enthralled agents act according to the previous night's state.

Possible day responses:

- v
i

l
l
a
g
e
r
s

s
e
a
r
c
h

t
h
e

c
a
s
t
l
e

g
r
o
u
n
d
s

- a

r
o
a
d

i
s

w
a
t
c
h
e

d

o

r

b

l

o

c

k

e

d

- a

b

r

i

d

g

e

i

s

g

u

a

r

d

e

d

o

r

b

u

r

n

e

d

- a

g

r

a

v

e

y

a
r
d

o
r

c
r
y
p
t

i
s

b
l
e
s
s
e
d

- a
n

e
a
r
t
h

c
r
a
t
e

i
s

d
i
s
c
o
v
e
r

e
d

o
r

d
e
s
t
r
o
y
e
d

- a

s
u
s
p
e
c
t
e
d

t
h
r
a
l
l

i
s

q
u
e
s
t
i
o
n
e
d

- p

o

r
t

c
a
r
g
o

i
s

d
e
l
a
y
e
d

o
r

i
n
s
p
e
c
t
e
d

-c

h
u
r
c
h

b
e
l
l
s

o
r

r

e
l
i
c
s

a
r
e

m
o
v
e
d

i
n
t
o

p
o
s
i
t
i
o
n

-o
n
e

s
a
f
e

r
o
u
t
e

b
e
c
o
m

e
s

u
n
s
a
f
e

-o
n
e

r
e
f
u
g
e

b
e
c
o
m
e
s

k
n
o
w
n

-f
e
a
r

r
i
s
e
s
,

c
a
u
s

i
n
g

m
i
s
t
a
k
e
s
,

p
a
n
i
c
,

o
r

h
a
r
s
h
e
r

c
o
u
n
t
e
r
m
e
a
s
u
r
e
s

Day is where the strategic pressure lands. Dracula is not "waiting scared"; he is bound

by mythic law. His night choices decide how much damage the day can do.

Progression Structure

Phase 1: The Castle Still Holds

The first nights teach the player that the castle is a power base, not a prison.

Goals:

- e
s
t
a
b
l
i
s
h

t
h
e

f
i
r
s
t

e
a
r
t
h

c
r
a
t
e
s
- l
e
a
r
n

t
h

e

d
a
y
/
n
i
g
h
t

r
h
y
t
h
m

-i

d
e
n
t
i
f
y

t
h
e

r
o
a
d

a
n
d

p
o
r
t

r
o
u
t

e

-f

e

e

d

w

i

t

h

o

u

t

c

r

e

a

t

i

n

g

t

o

o

m

u

c

h

a

l

a

r

m

-a

c

q

u

i

r

e

t

h

e

f
i
r
s
t

h
u
m
a
n

a
g
e
n
t

Tone:

Dracula feels in control. The villagers are distant noise, rumor, and smoke below the mountain.

Phase 2: The Villages Wake

The countryside begins to connect incidents.

Goals:

- m
o
v
e

c
r
a
t
e
s

b
e
y
o
n
d

t
h
e

c
a
s
t
l
e
-d
i
v
i
d
e

t
h
e

v
i
l
l
a
g
e
s

b
e
f
o
r
e

t
h
e
y

c
o
o
r
d
i
n
a
t
e

-s

e
c
u
r
e

a

c
o
a
c
h

o
r

c
a
r
t

r
o
u
t
e

-p

r
e
v
e
n
t

t
h
e

c
h
u
r
c
h

f
r

o
m

s
a
n
c
t
i
f
y
i
n
g

k
e
y

r
o
a
d
s

-g
a
i
n

a

d
a
y
-
a
c
t
i
n
g

a
g
e
n
t

i

n

t

h

e

p

o

r

t

o

r

c

u

s

t

o

m

s

c

h

a

i

n

Tone:

The danger becomes logistical. Villagers are still prey at night, but they are becoming a system by day.

Phase 3: Consecrated Ground

The map starts to close.

Goals:

- k

e

e

p

a

t

l

e

a

s

t

o
n
e

r
o
u
t
e

t
o

t
h
e

p
o
r
t

v
i
a
b
l
e

-p

r
o
t
e
c
t

r
e
m
a
i
n
i
n
g

e

a
r
t
h

c
r
a
t
e
s

-c

o
u
n
t
e
r

r
e
l
i
c
s

,

b
e
l
l
s

,

p
a
t
r
o
l
s

,

a
n
d

b
l

e
s
s
e
d

t
h
r
e
s
h
o
l
d
s

-c

h
o
o
s
e

w
h
e
t
h
e
r

t
o

b
e

s
u
b
t
l
e

o
r

b
r

u
t
a
l
- d
e
c
i
d
e

w
h
i
c
h

a
s
s
e
t
s

c
a
n

b
e

a
b
a
n
d
o
n
e
d

Tone:

Dracula's power is still terrifying, but careless power now creates heat. The player should feel the arrogance of the monster meeting the arithmetic of daylight.

Phase 4: The Demeter Window

The ship is reachable only for a short window.

Goals:

- m

o
v
e

t
h
e

f
i
n
a
l

c
r
a
t
e

o
r

s
e
a
l

t
h
e

c
a
r
g
o

- k

e
e
p

t
h
e

s
h

i
p
p
i
n
g

p
a
p
e
r
s

v
a
l
i
d

-p
r
e
v
e
n
t

l
a
s
t
-
n
i
g
h
t

i
n
s
p
e
c
t
i
o
n

-b

o
a
r
d
,

h
i
d
e
,

o
r

t
r
a
n
s
f
e
r

t
h
r
o
u
g
h

a
n

a
g
e
n
t

-I

e
a
v
e

e
n
o

u
g
h

c
o
n
f
u
s
i
o
n

b
e
h
i
n
d

t
h
a
t

t
h
e

d
e
p
a
r
t
u
r
e

i
s

n
o
t

s
t

o
p
p
e
d

Tone:

This is the exfiltration climax: not a boss fight, but a tightening net of choices, routes, and consequences.

Player Fantasy

The player fantasy is not "Dracula the victim."

It is:

- D

r
a
c
u
l
a

a
s

a

p
r
e
d
a
t
o
r

w
i
t
h

a
n

i
t
i
n

e
r
a
r
y
-D
r
a
c
u
l
a

a
s

a

n
o
b
l
e
m
a
n

u
s
i
n
g

f
e
a
r
,

l
a
w
,

m
o
n
e
y

,

b
l
o
o
d

,

a
n
d

s
u
p
e
r
s
t
i
t
i
o
n

a
s

t
o
o
l
s

-D

r
a
c
u
l
a

a
s

a

s
u

p
e
r
n
a
t
u
r
a
l

s
t
r
a
t
e
g
i
s
t

c
o
n
s
t
r
a
i
n
e
d

b
y

o
l
d

r
u
l
e
s

- Dracula as cargo, corpse, aristocrat, rumor, wolf, mist, and plague depending on the hour

At night, he is the monster.

By day, he is a secret that must not be found.

Villager Threat Model

Villagers should rarely be dangerous because a single villager can beat Dracula. They are dangerous because they can:

- s

e

e

w

h

a

t

h

e

c

a

n

n

o

t

s

e

e

w

h

i

l

e

h

e

s

l

e

e

p

s

- a

c

t

w
h
e
r
e

h
e

c
a
n
n
o
t

a
c
t

d
u
r
i
n
g

t
h
e

d
a
y

-d
e
s
t
r
o
y

t
h
e

i
n

f
r
a
s
t
r
u
c
t
u
r
e

o
f

e
s
c
a
p
e

-c

r
e
a
t
e

b
l
e
s
s
e
d

n
o
-
g
o

z
o
n
e
s

-c

h
a
n
g
e

t
h
e

s
o
c
i
a
l

s
t
a
t
e

o
f

t
h
e

m
a
p

-f

o
r
c
e

h
i
m

t
o

s
p
e

n
d

n
i
g
h
t

a
c
t
i
o
n
s

r
e
p
a
i
r
i
n
g

d
a
m
a
g
e

i
n
s
t
e
a
d

o
f

a
d
v
a

n
c
i
n
g

t
h
e

p
l
a
n

The mob is a pressure system, not a boss monster.

Quest Language

Avoid framing tasks as timid survival goals.

Weak framing:

- S
u
r
v
i
v
e

u
n
t
i
l

t
h
e

D
e
m
e
t
e
r

l

e
a
v
e
s

.

-A

v
o
i
d

t
h
e

a
n
g
r
y

v
i
l
l
a
g
e
r
s

.

-D

o

n
o
t

g
e
t

c
a
u
g
h
t

.

Stronger framing:

- P

r
e
p
a
r
e

t
h
e

p
a
s
s
a
g
e

.

- M

o
v
e

t
h
e

n
a
t
i
v
e

e
a
r
t
h

.

- S

e
c
u

r
e

t
h
e

m
a
n
i
f
e
s
t

.

-S

i
l
l
e
n
c
e

t
h
e

b
e
l
l

t
o
w
e
r

.

-T

u
r
n

t
h
e

c

l
e
r
k
.

-K
e
e
p

t
h
e

r
o
a
d

u
n
b
l
e
s
s
e
d

-D
i
v
i
d
e

t
h
e

v
i
l
l
a
g
e
s
.

- S
e
a
l

t
h
e

c
a
r
g
o

b
e
f
o
r
e

d
a
w
n
.

This keeps Dracula active and dangerous.

Trailer Shape

The trailer should sell contrast:

1. A castle room, still and luxurious.
2. Dracula crosses a blood-red threshold at night.
3. A villager window goes dark.
4. An earth crate is dragged through mist.
5. A church bell begins ringing at dawn.
6. Daylight map state: roads marked, fires lit, one refuge burned.
7. Night again: Dracula chooses another route.
8. The port and the Demeter appear as the objective.
9. Final line: "Prepare the passage before the land wakes."

Design North Star

Every system should preserve one idea:

Dracula is not afraid of villagers. Dracula is afraid of time, sunlight, consecration, and exposure.

The game is compelling when the player feels powerful at night, constrained by day, and responsible for turning raw horror into a successful escape.